

EXHIBITION

Naturaleza Muerta

Still Life

Doma

May - August

CENTRO CULTURAL RECOLETA

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CULTURAL
RECOLETA

Naturaleza Muerta

Still Life

Artists: Doma

Cronopios Room

Tuesdays - Fridays 1:30 p.m. – 10:00 p.m. Saturdays, Sundays and holidays 11:15 a.m. – 10:00 p.m.
Free admission

#domanaturalezamuerta
#domaenelRecoleta

Where is humanity headed?

This question storms us, surrounded by multiple changes we can't quite take in. For little over a decade, portable screens and social media have exponentially modified our behaviour and ways to relate in unexpected and contradictory ways. In the setting up of new models of communication a fantasy of connecting more people has emerged. But that "connection" is strengthened as it implies the internalization of behaviours and movements that physically disconnect us; which divide separate and distance us.

At first, any sign of capitalist expansion may be perceived as a synonym for development. However, we must point out that it is a matter of viewpoints (and their veils). Depression is a disease expanding significantly and has turned into the first cause of disability in the world. Youth and adults are isolated and drawn inwards more and more, thus exponentially increasing the consumption of psychoactive drugs or the practice of self-destructive behaviours to avoid anxiety, distress, loneliness and pain. We move in time within a process of internalization, neutralization and normalization.

Let us not forget the increase in child psychopathologies. We are promoting lack of self-awareness in children in relation to those who surround them. Children who, ultimately, prefer to find their own ways to stimulate themselves and to regulate themselves; who feel overwhelmed by the stimuli within their contexts, all while their parents dress them up in adult clothing and brag about them learning to use a smartphone function at an early age.

Hyper-consumerist society dictates the standards of happiness, beauty and success that we should achieve and the family models to follow, turning subjects into machines of self-surpassing pursuit —an endless race whose purpose is self-exploitation rather than self-realization.
Like a great evil spiral, we are more concerned with designing the lives we will show others than with feeling and documenting stories, benchmarks, memories, pain and sensations of our own identity. Te image of what we are —that need to compete for the most likes, hits and recognition— has taken over our own experiences.

Comparison is on the rise and, with it; the envy of wanting what the other one is showing; wanting what the other one has. Is it not that feeling of scarcity which turns us into obedient consumers? We feel that what we have and are is never enough.

We place ourselves subjectively in the world as individuals who are thought of as isolated from the human race we are part of. We feel insufficient; we have to compete with others to show ourselves good or deserving respect, wealth, love and fame.

We see society, in this first contact with the new technologies, as teenagers first experimenting with alcohol or drugs, without finding their limits and not knowing how to grasp them or make the most of their own potential.
We are turning into an increasingly sedentary species. Our bodies have been colonized by the cultural poison we are being daily introjected, not being able to use these new means as tools.

Doma brings back a key teaching conveyed by German philosopher and critic Walter Benjamin in the pursuit of for authenticity and struggle. Before continuing to adapt, consume and act, we must go through an authentic moment of contemplation and acceptance. We must accept this which we have done, what's happening and all which seems to have been imposed upon us as the only possibility.

Welcome to the sublimation of contradiction: a phenomenology of the disaster of human evolution; of the cleft made by progress.

Technology is by definition a group of knowledge devoted to come up with inventions which improve people's quality of life. Let's use the weapons we have created to defend our freedom and our right to be respected. Obedience is killing us.

In *Society of the Spectacle,* Guy Debord states: "In societies where modern conditions of production prevail, all of life presents itself as an immense accumulation of spectacles. Everything that was directly lived has moved away into a representation." We can't ignore contradiction is a core human issue, which is the object of the current mode of production. Doma's works seek for us to come face to face with this view. Internet, social media, beauty standards, success and happiness. Hyper-consumerist society. Patriarchy. The obscurity of childhood. Technological development. Poverty. Corruption. War.

"Facts do not cease to exist because they are ignored." Aldous Huxley

"In times of universal deceit, telling the truth is a revolutionary act." George Orwell.

"In Orwell's *1984* society knew it was being dominated. Today we are not even aware of the domination (...). Today a person exploits themselves believing they are fulfilling themselves." Byung-Chul Han

These three quotes are used to reference a dialectic process that enables us to bring these texts forward as prophecies of a crisis which isn't random and which isn't foreign to the historical processes that precede us.
The current truth crisis is in no way connected to the ideal of knowing the unknowable, but to denying reality, to pretend that what's right under our



Society of the Spectacle book cover, Guy Debord, 1967

noses isn't happening. We need to expel the mask covering the ideology we are being fed through each commercial, each influence, each reference point, each consume object.

The bank does not loan you money, it takes from you. A beach holiday isn't going to free you of the oppression of a soul-devouring job. Cosmetology is not about health, but about perpetuating hegemonic beauty.

Once we connect to the immanent ideology behind everything, we may restart to design our lives. In terms of Slovenian philosopher and sociologist Slavoj Žižek, once we've faced the pain of being free.

Theerefore, in this exhibition we will not attempt to halt any process, but to shed light to processes unaware of the self. To fight advanced capitalism's noumena, the acceptance of how the circulation of capital should be at the expense of whatever such circulation may require. Thus turning capital into a sort of God; a supreme, sacred commodity.

Welcome.



Image taken from Mark Zuckerberg's personal Facebook page, February 21, 2016

Bienvenidos | Welcome

Participatory Installation
Intervened coffin / 400 x 100 x 200 cm

In 2016 114 sleeping and anxiolytic pills were sold per second in Argentina alone.

Argentines consume 10 million pills a day.

Don't you feel you live in a society made up of a majority swinging from apathy to self-destructive wrath as a way to be?

We are living in a present time with no role models, no future collective promises worth fighting or making sacrifices for. We are stuck in a present time loop. We are forced to push the circulation of capital.

Consumption for its own's sake.
Bodies are being tamed.
Humanity: lifeless.

Concerning those thoughts, we lead a life where our bodies are aware and available, our pores, open; our eyes, attentive; our ears, charged, criticizing the endless, perversely stupefying messages we are introjected every day, in a passionate struggle to live. LIVE!

Carpentry and laquer: Racco e Hijos.
Assembly assistant and finishing: Luciano Iannuzzi.





Matafama | Famekiller

Participatory installation
600 x 300 x 180 cm

In 2004 there was an AK-47 every 60 citizens and every year 250,000 people die by injuries caused by them. There are almost 100 million models around. It is the weapon which has caused the most deaths in history.

We are going through a time marked by the tendency to publicize our lives. Therefore, we now know that in postmodern times what matters is the design of the self as a bonding activity. As standardized symbols built up as signs of authenticity are reproduced. Everybody's doing the same thing: seeking more likes, more followers, more views and greater validation.

German thinker and writer Boris Groys pointed out a difference to think about this phenomenon of imitation, this showing off of a non-existing singularity, and says that "what is done" is not as important as "what is shown," what we say we are.

This burns out the possibility of acting. All of our new resources are projected onto the mirror that public image has become. That's why we dry up in unison. Something dies: the dignifying action of becoming ourselves through what we do.

Technical execution: Martín López Palermo y Nicolás Stavorengo.

Culopedal | Bum pedal

Kinetic sculpture
120 x 40 x 70 cm

“This might be our desperate cry to a heteronormative society plotting to objectify women. The cult of the body, the value in being an object of desire.” UnDoma

“Not many men have even a moderately right idea of what a woman is. It requires a complicated degree of interest, and almost all the interest which men have in women is too basic.” Simone de Beauvoir

The Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW) acknowledges the impact of gender stereotypes as an obstacle in gender equality and women empowerment.

Where can those who only see themselves as sexual objects find their identity, then? How is our human relation-impaired and sex object relation-driven subjectivity to be enriched? Why is it possible to see a body as a container, a contour, and, ever more, as a barren object? Organ-less bodies, busted subjectivity. How have we learnt that so well?

Technical execution: Christian Scherf / Fixxon (San Pablo, Brasil).





Crossfit

Stainless steel Intervened slide
450 x 80 x 240 cm

“Words are at waste when trying to explain consciousness, since it is the body we ignore. No one yet has determined what the body can do.” Baruch Spinoza

How much potential is held within a body, a spirit, a mind, the unfathomable spectrum of emotions and sensations? Isn’t a human being a sensation-creating machine? [These sensations] are impossible to reproduce in any other body and impossible to even out with words. Sensations cannot come from an organic or concrete form. Isn’t organic experience an endless number of interpretations?

We become these office-, couch-, bus seat- and TV-bound, sedentary beings who want to do crossfit for recreation and entertainment. This is only possible in postmodern times. It reflects the insecurity which turns into a need to build ourselves copying that which has been accepted, what’s hegemonic. It implies, at the same time, this over-demand of the body, it not only being an organic receptacle, but a machine capable of producing, receiving, echoing and multiplying infinite affects.

We continue to reflect upon the imposed ideals and their unattainability as well as upon our own stubbornness in trying to reach them and the traps hidden inside the hegemonic body. This body voices a threat against our subjectivity.

Assistant: Ing. Gonzalo Teijeiro.
Metalsmith: Gustavo Pirillo.

Ego

Mixed media sculpture
250 x 350 x 250 cm

Sometimes it seems we only come to existence when there's another person looking.
In the eyes of another one.
I exist.

Instead of uniting with our egos to make an imprint upon our community, we go through the reverse process: we unite to the reflection our community's eye has created in order to imprint that image of our egos upon our own egos.

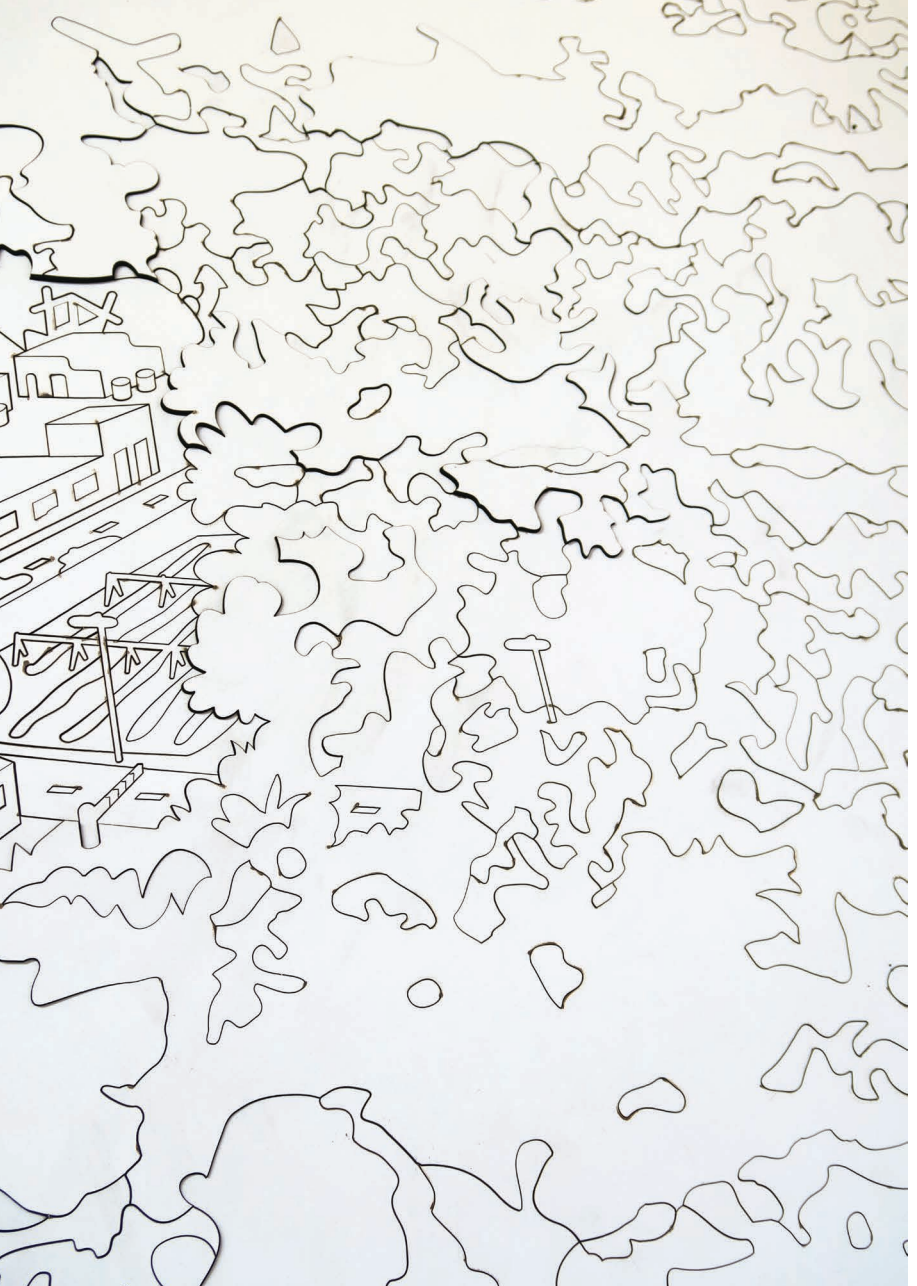
Thus, instead of engaging with the process of giving in order to expand ourselves and learn about ourselves in the world, we bond with others through what we are given, since we would not exist otherwise. As Pichon Riviére put it, our egos have blinded us and we can no longer see, learn, or grow.

The ego of a merely self-referential artist might be like this. Indeed, this is criticism of those whose work is made only in relation with their own selves, who aren't connected to the community they belong to. Perhaps a spiritual dimension may lead us to become aware that we are a small part of a whole.

What would it be like to live beyond our egos?

Carpentry assistant: Luciano Iannuzzi.
Gold plating: José Abreu.





Versus

Painting made with pieces fitted together
Diptych / x2 120 x 90 cm

Today's undeniable mix between urban and natural territories can become the portrait of a phenomenon that involve us and from which it isn't worth running.

This phenomenon implies that, if we've made it here, it isn't merely because of an ability to unveil reality and clearly observe the power struggles underlying every social construct. When we come to accept that there is loneliness, pain, malice in the world; we also come to acknowledge that there is another side to life. The side encompassing love, learning together and the strength to do good. That's why it's worth living.

Isn't this proof that opposites meet, depend on one another and are evident?

Finding that life makes its way through, like a small plant sprouting from the cracks of an old building.
Finding that there is poetry, as when a white nylon bag flies about over a mountain getting lost in the clouds.

Production assistants: Luciano Iannuzzi y Joaquín Longinotti.

Naturaleza Muerta | Still Life

Video-installation with 6 screens

The biggest online porn consumers are teenagers between the ages of 12 and 17, according to a study carried out by the University of Zaragoza, published by Matías Labay Guerrero.

Teenagers are beginning to take up the sexual market not only as consumers, but as producers, as well. It doesn't take more than a webcam and good Internet connection.

Before passing judgement, we've delved into the thought that this behaviour might not be illogical. Who'd rather work as a fast-food clerk when they can make use of their own time and over-charge by the hour? We are systematically leading teenagers to consume. What are they doing if not looking for the means to fulfil their ultimate duty?

Postmodern youth don't believe in revolutionary struggles, instead, they seek emancipation, a crack which enables them to get some economic freedom. What body isn't but a commodity in a capitalist system? Aren't these the bodies pierced through culture that Pierre Bourdieu talked about?

We've taken snippets of halted time, unproductive time amid LiveSexCams sessions. Almost like a nostalgic longing of a worldview that seems to be dispelling for good.

Technical execution: Martín López Palermo y Nicolás Stavorengo.







Mantra

Light and sound sculpture
Stainless steel / 150 x 150 x 500 cm

Data. Every second, data traffic in the world surpasses the number of humans, added to the number of coca-colas, photographs and thousands more categories we could name.

Whereas reality is a continuum; us, humans try to discretize it to the point of producing and processing millions of data from one moment to another.

Telecommunications are the fundamental technology of our time. Little by little they're taking up the different landscapes with their invisible radiation and control plan: expansion and domination.

It isn't merely a matter of sending and receiving information, but of being watched. It's essential because it is the means where the essence of the current model of production lies.

The interfaces on social media and apps we use allure us with their vibrations and sounds. We get trained to learn their distinctions, their social value, and their hierarchies every day –due to repetition, as a mantra of hyper-connection.

Blueprints: Luciano Iannuzzi.
Metalsmith: Gustavo Pirillo.
Electronics and programming: Martín López Palermo y Nicolás Stavorengo.
Structural assistant: Ing. Gonzalo Teijeiro.

Fighting Point

Wall object
Backlit device / 40 x 40 cm

No. This isn't signage at the Recoleta; it's a work of art.
But, who's to say in the future there won't be spaces dedicated to validating this oh-so-common social behaviour: fighting?

One of the first actions by Doma back in the '90s was intervening signage within the urban area, twisting their meaning. This work takes back such actions to denounce a current situation: the fatal cocktail that is to coexist in this advanced capitalism, which ends up dividing and creating cracks among groups of people who have different political, ethnic and religious views, i.e., among those who see themselves as different.

Power has been wise to historically accentuate these gaps to better sell the idea that we need paternalistic authorities to tell us what to do. We aren't but unruly, naughty, fickle and contentious children.





La Fuente de la Vida | The Fountain of Life

Installation with 7 ball-jointed dolls

Ever since UNICEF sarted its “Hablemos del abuso infantil” (Let’s talk about child abuse) campaign in Argentina in 2016 60% of the calls reported abuse on girls by the hand of their parents.

The mask over beauty stereotypes, fitness and fashion hides an ideology of dehumanized and objectified sexualisation of women. This stereotype is being imprinted upon girls’ personal image at an earlier age. Idols become patriarchy’s militants. Video clips, movies and TV shows promote rape and the oppression of women. Her body: a commodity.

This is how a system is built to take advantage of the innocence and openness of childhood a symbolic area to conquer. Once this stereotype forms in the early years, this being a key stage, it becomes even easier to train it to be obedient and exploited. For others, for abuse and dehumanization.

Ergo, perversion.

Costumes: Poty Hernández.
Modelling and moulds: Fernando Cimino y Willy Wells.
Limb modelling and copies: Leonardo Castillo y Federico Castillo.
Assistance and fountain builder: Grupo Bondi.
Masks: Christian Scherf / Fixxon (San Pablo, Brasil).
Assistant carpenters: Eugenio Ángel Tornadu y Luciano Iannuzzi.
Footwear assistant: Xoxu (San Pablo, Brasil).

Muñeco de Apego | Comfort Object

Installation with 7 ball-jointed dolls

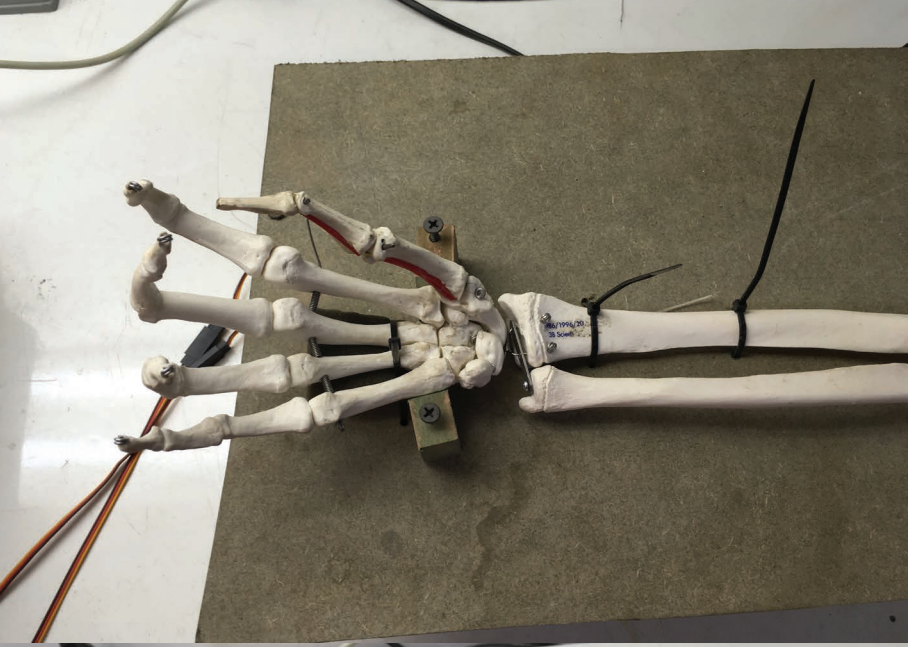
Passiveness and receptiveness enable the introjection of content and emotional self-regulatory responses which, as in a loop, provide entertainment in order to create even greater passiveness and receptiveness. Thus the body, the mind, the spirit and emotions are trapped in a state of immaturity, where there's a lack of openness to forge bonds with one another. Maturity is mistaken for the perpetuation of the need for a reliable stimulus, i.e., a comfort object.

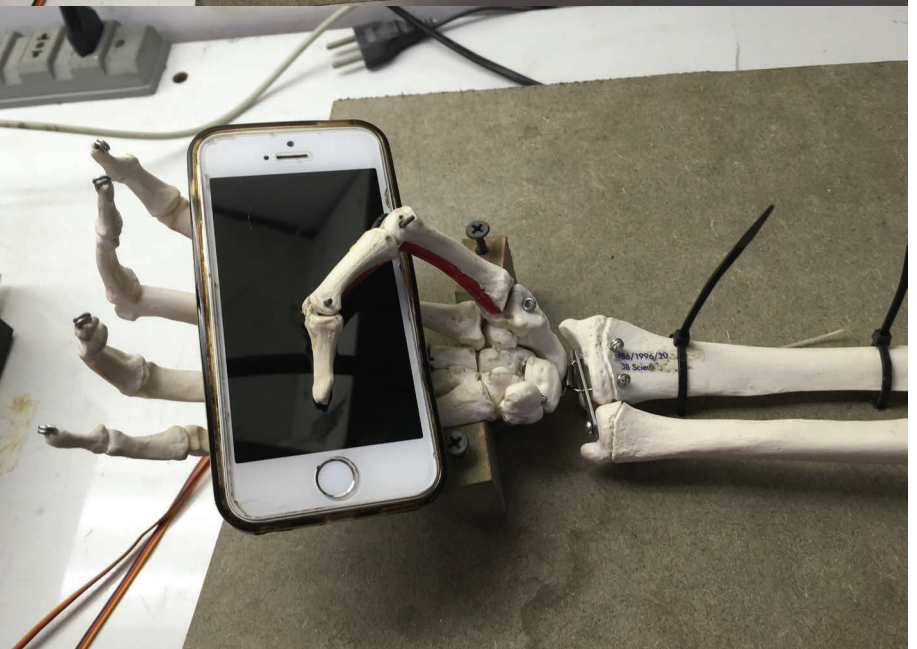
A transitional object for a transition that just never happens.

When does the average human mature? When does it procure to explore all of its sides towards a conscious independence? Or, better yet, towards being conscious of, at least, its own independence?

Costumes: Poty Hernández.
Electronics and programming: Martín López Palermo y Nicolás Stavorengo.
Mask modelling: Fernando Cimino.
Hand modelling and moulding: Leonardo Castillo.
Masks: Christian Scherf / Fixxon (San Pablo, Brasil).
Assistant carpenter: Eugenio Ángel Tornadu y Luciano Iannuzzi.
Footwear assistant: Xoxu (San Pablo, Brasil).
Geese: Norma Roldán.







Scroll

Kinetic sculpture
80 x 30 x 150 cm

What would an average human's remains or scraps be like? What would happen if a here-and-now human body were to be animated in a future society? What gestures and movement would seem ordinary or distinctive of this moment in time of our species?

According to philosopher Walter Benjamin, we become historically aware as beings when we come into contact with the remnants history has left behind, its scraps, rather than when we experience history. It just might be that without a real passive moment, nothing new can emerge.

That's why, before passing judgement on our cultural mutations, they need to be observed and contemplated in silence, as when looking at a mummy at a museum. Motionless. Letting questions, sensations, images and memories come up. Just for a moment, to break free from our positions as all-accepting, non-questioning, blinded passive soldiers.

How bad could it be to break free of this infinite cycle of utilitarianism and functionality?

Technical execution: Christian Scherf / Fixxon (San Pablo, Brasil).

Políticos | Politicians

Wooden diorama
40 x 35 x 60 cm

"This is our monument to falsehood. Whoever believes democracy is an efficient system and that votes are the people's 'voices' is affiliated to a sort of fun-deprived circus clown." UnDoma.

"Political language is designed to make lies sound truthful and murder respectable, and to give an appearance of solidity to pure wind." George Orwell

Politics today aren't but the construction and the design of resources acting as placebos for social emergencies. Politicians are bought and trained to become professional actors able to win over social trust. The art of public untruth is solidified as the great contemporary political feat.

"(...) the more sinister the designs of a politician, the more high-flown, as a rule, becomes the nobility of his language." Aldous Huxley

"(...) sixty-two thousand repetitions in the dark had made them accept, not merely as true, but as axiomatic, self-evident, utterly indisputable." Aldous Huxley, A Brave New World

3D modelling: Fernando Cimino.
Prototype: Frank Bross (Amsterdam, Holanda).
Wodden piece: 3D Wood (Ortisei, Italia).





Constitución | Constitution

Large-scale print
100% cotton paper / 180 x 120 cm
3 colors, aluminium-base silver

What would the imagery of a children's textbook about contemporary life look like? What would their duties and inter-personal skills be like?

Society is built on the basis of rights, restrictions and liberties, the constitution is a document which lists them and defines their scope and limitations. Being part of a society dominated by the restriction of our liberties leads us to think that, once more, we are in need of a hand-written, socially-validated letter to keep us disciplined because it seems we can't be civilized without the presence of governing authorities.

This graphic representation is no more (no less) than the chaos in which we coexist beyond what our constitution says. With or without it, "civilization" is nothing but one more false and fanciful construct our species is nowhere near to achieve.

Printer: Guido Avramides.
Assistant printers: Luciano Iannuzzi y Joaquín Longinotti.
Illustration collaborator: Agustín Viguera.
Framing: Mónica Otero.

Redención | Redemption

Paritcipatory installation
440 x 150 x 300 cm

“Destroy the old world; forge a new world.” China’s Cultural Revolution poster (Mao Zedong)

If we can find at least a glimpse of self-honesty in all these delights —a sort of honesty to oneself— let us start building an opening to new escape routes. The feasibility to do something distinctive. It seems as if we have been stuck in a destructive spiral with no news on that new world project. Or is this it? If this is the ‘new world’ heralded in the past, who, of those past actors, would want to come to this present time?

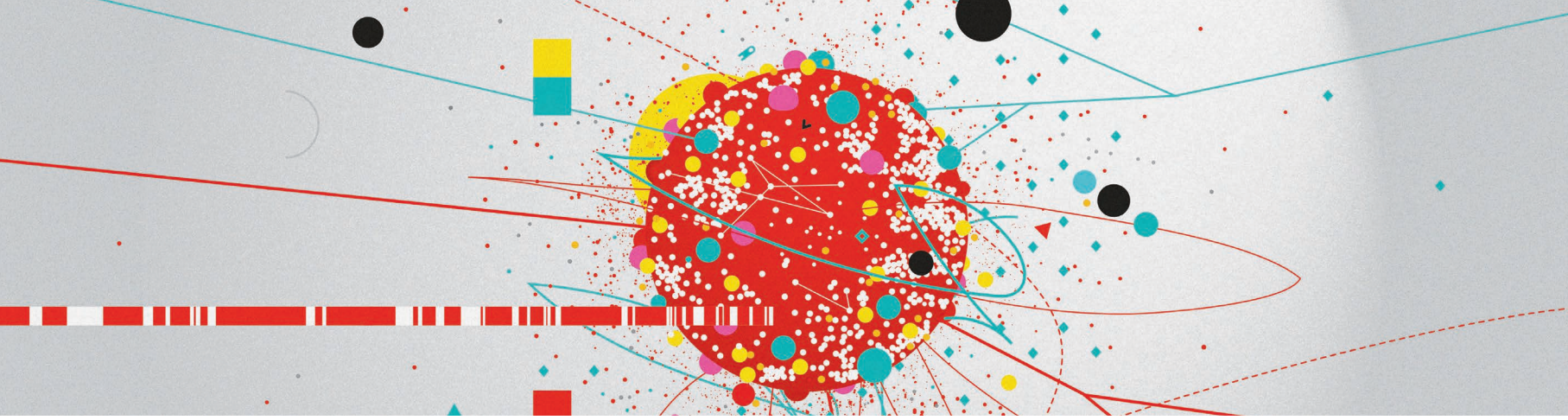
We are instilled guilt by religion and more, to weight-loss reality TV shows. That squeamish inner demon. Guilt distances us from the ability to accept and forgive, primarily, ourselves.

How about we stop fearing being human and making thousands of mistakes? Becoming a swarm of mistakes?

How about we accept and forgive ourselves in order to set off on a quest towards justice, equality and good? We could break the cycle of inner slavery and oppression and seek collective organizations with that same end in view. In the hopes that stupidity and apathy will no longer be in fashion once and for all. For looking in the mirror no longer being a way to increase our insecurity, but our awareness of our own existence.
Telling us we are here and open.
We are not closed up beings. Open affordances.
Willing.
Organized.
Fighting for life.

Production: Taller ElectroLight.
Structural assistant: Ing. Gonzalo Teijeiro.





Doma

Doma is an artist collective formed in 1998 in Buenos Aires, Argentina. Its production is characterized by a critical and biting view on reality's absurdity. Their focus is on where contradiction and paradox reside.

Their work comprises various formats and interdisciplinary works harnessing different technologies. From miniature pieces to large-scale projects. Ever since their origins in urban art, collaborative work, experimentation and DIY have been the axis of their practice.

The founding members of the group met at the Faculty of Architecture, Design and Urbanism (FADU), UBA, while studying Graphic Design and Image and Sound Design and upon graduating, working as professors.

Doma compiled its actions in a self-published book called Doma00, which started a domino effect that included the invitation to show at MALBA's Contemporáneos 2 exhibition in 2002. That same year they won Ruth Benzacar's Curriculum Cero award and had a show in the gallery in 2003. Between 2004 and 2005 they became allies of the mythic The Locomotion Channel.

They are the creators of Coloso in Tecnópolis (Buenos Aires) and their 2007's Dunny is featured in Moma's permanent collection. They have kept touring and exhibiting around the globe still using public space as the inception of all their universes.

With the help of good fortune, drive and people around them, the domino effect has been ongoing until today.
They have worked non-stop for 20 years trying to disrupt processes of symbolic perception, using the system's own codes and looking for new viewpoints, actions and reactions.

Nowadays, this collective speaks to a new process of contraction of capitalism and is devoted to producing content and work that will inspire, open people's eyes and spread strength to cope with what's going on in the world and what's to come.
Doma collective is currently run by Orilo Blandini and Julián Manzelli.
"We're living in an environment that's calling to action." Doma, 1998.
"What is the perfect scenario for youth? Crisis, where there's no law, no order and everything is on the verge of beginning..." Doma, 2002.

@domacollective
www.doma.tv

DOMA:
Orilo Blandini + Julián Manzelli.

General Producer:
Doma + Kültur Büro Buenos Aires.

Assistant director:
Mario Rebecca.

Management / consulting:
Sigismond De Vajay + María Paoli.

Texts:
Doma + Gala Lucía González.

Photographic record:
Doma + Ezequiel Hilbert.

***Apuntes sobre Doma* Documentary video:**
Ezequiel Hilbert.

Cover photograph:
Doma.

Recoleta team:
Visual arts production coordinator: Verónica Otero.
Executive producer: Matías Tapia.

Thanks:
Familias Manzelli, Blandini & Rebecca, María Josefina Ricca, Adriana Gómez, Sabrina Sbrascini, Mariano Barbieri, Matías Vigliano, Daniel Platero, Domingo Sbrascini, Tec, Tristan Rault, Fleur Kesic, Coskun Gueven, Mónica Robinson, Luciano Iannuzzi, Pol Corona, Ivanna Locmanidis, Magosh_vr, Skinny, La Boca, Camila Raysa, Jimmy, María Sousa, Luz Riegelhaupt, Pedro Perelman, Anahí Traba, Carlos Venancio, Victoria Tolomei y a todos los que se han cruzado en nuestro camino e intercambiado con nosotros alguna forma de enriquecimiento. Equipo Centro Cultural Recoleta por colaborar tanto en esta experiencia increíble.

AVALA CYNAR · SULLAIR CULTURA · KBB Kültur Büro Buenos Aires · PIZZINI · Sinteplast

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